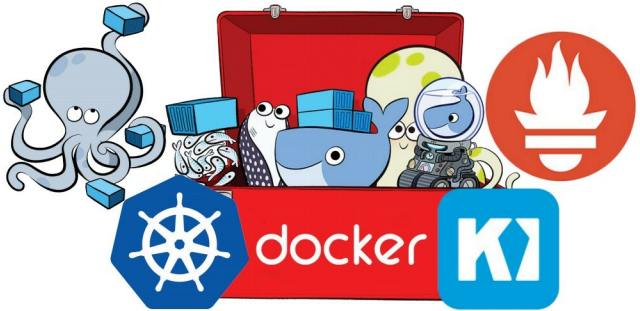


Docker Tools that Developers will Find Useful

Docker allows IT departments to focus on applications, not virtual machines, as a standard unit of production. Looking at recent trends, there have been many projects created by the Docker community that have advanced the developer experience. This article takes a look at a few Docker tools that may be useful for developers.



Docker was introduced to the world with no prior announcement, by Solomon Hykes, founder and CEO of dotCloud at the Python Developers Conference in Santa Clara, California on March 15, 2013. Hykes started Docker in France as an internal project within dotCloud, a PaaS company, with contributions from other dotCloud engineers including Andrea Luzzardi and Francois-Xavier Bourlet. The Docker project was quickly made open source and became available to the public on GitHub in March 2014, with the release of version 0.9.

Docker is an open source project that automates the deployment of Linux applications inside software containers.

As per the official website, *docker.com*, “Docker containers wrap up a piece of software in a complete file system that contains everything it needs to run: code, runtime, system tools, system libraries -- anything you can install on a server. This guarantees that it will always run the same, regardless of the environment it is running in.”

Docker can be integrated into various infrastructure tools, including Amazon Web Services, Ansible, CFEngine, Chef, Google Cloud Platform, IBM Bluemix, Jelastic, Jenkins, Microsoft Azure, OpenStack Nova, OpenSVC, HPE

Helion Stackato, Puppet, Salt, Vagrant and VMware vSphere integrated containers.

Key benefits of using Docker

Currently, Docker is regarded as the hottest open source project that allows users to deploy applications inside containers, adding a layer of abstraction. It is gaining a lot of traction in the development and DevOps worlds for its consistency across environments. Docker technology has seen consistent and rapid adoption in key enterprises like Microsoft, Google, etc, because of a number of advantages, which are listed below.

- **Simple configuration:** Docker provides simple configuration. VMs, too, can run on any platform with their own *config* on top of the infrastructure. Docker, however, offers the same capability without the overhead of a virtual machine. It lets the user put environment and configuration into code for deployment to be done. Docker gives the user freedom to run applications across multiple IaaS/PaaS solutions without any tweaks.
- **Developer friendly:** Docker provides a developer-friendly environment via a low memory capacity and allows easy running of dozens of services.